

Caterpillars take a long time to digest food.

Treacherous teeth

Caterpillars are typical vegetarian biters and chewers. They have strong jaws that can get through tough leaves. It is thought that insects eat about 5 per cent of all leaves in the world.

Turn and learn

Butterflies and moths: pp. 118-119

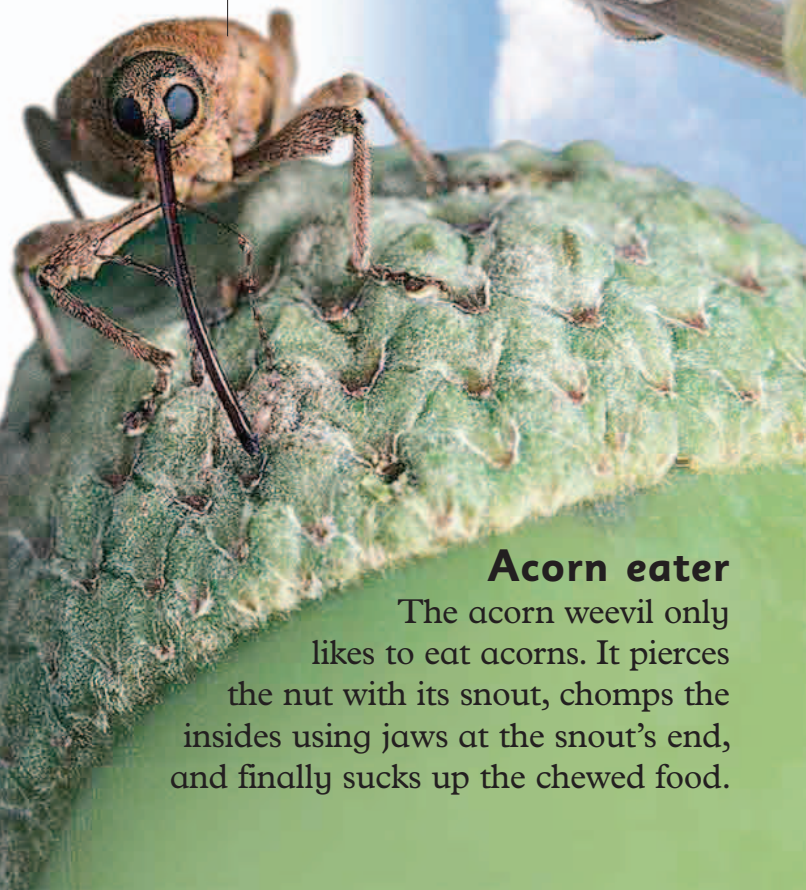
A butterfly lays her eggs on a leaf that will be the caterpillar's first meal – it doesn't have to travel very far to find food.

This weevil has drilled a hole in an acorn.



Alligator tears

A butterfly has a long tongue called a proboscis, which it uses to sip liquids. The flambeau butterfly has very strange taste in food; it likes to sip alligators' tears. What a brave insect!



Acorn eater

The acorn weevil only likes to eat acorns. It pierces the nut with its snout, chomps the insides using jaws at the snout's end, and finally sucks up the chewed food.